MTR/COA Automation Readiness Assessment

A 5-minute diagnostic for steel & metals quality, operations and digital transformation teams

Purpose. Use this assessment to identify where your current MTR/COA process sits between manual document handling and a connected, validated automation workflow. Select the answer that best describes your current state.

Scoring: Early = 1 point | Developing = 2 | Advanced = 3 | Ready = 4

Assessment

1. Document volume How many MTRs/COAs does your team process in a typical month?

☐ <500 ☐ 500–2,000 ☐ 2,000–10,000 ☐ 10,000+

2. Supplier variability How many different supplier formats/templates do you encounter?

☐ 1–5 ☐ 6–20 ☐ 21–50 ☐ 50+

3. Document types What formats are commonly received?

☐ Native PDFs ☐ Scanned PDFs ☐ Images ☐ Spreadsheets ☐ Mixed

4. Manual data entry How much certificate data is manually keyed into ERP/QMS/LIMS or spreadsheets?

☐ Almost none ☐ Some ☐ Significant ☐ Most/all

5. Extraction Can your current process reliably extract heat numbers, grades, chemistry and mechanical properties?

☐ Yes ☐ Mostly ☐ Partially ☐ No

6. Validation Are certificate values automatically checked against specifications, orders or quality rules?

☐ Yes, extensively ☐ Some checks ☐ Mostly manual ☐ No

7. Traceability Can you reliably link a certificate to heat/lot/material/order records?

☐ End-to-end ☐ Mostly ☐ Partially ☐ Manual

8. Exceptions How are missing fields, low-confidence values or failed validations handled?

☐ Automated workflow ☐ Structured review ☐ Email/spreadsheets ☐ Ad hoc

9. Integration Does certificate data flow automatically into your ERP/QMS/LIMS?

☐ Yes ☐ Partially ☐ Export/import ☐ Manual

10. Audit readiness Can you quickly show what was extracted, validated, changed and approved?

☐ Yes ☐ Mostly ☐ Partially ☐ No

11. Scalability What happens when certificate volume or supplier count increases?

☐ Scales easily ☐ Some added effort ☐ Significant manual effort ☐ Becomes a bottleneck

12. Improvement priority How important is MTR/COA automation in the next 12–18 months?

☐ Low ☐ Moderate ☐ High ☐ Strategic priority

Calculate Your Readiness Score

Give each selected answer 1–4 points. Add your 12 answers. Maximum score: 48.

Score	Readiness level	What it means
12–23	EARLY STAGE	MTR/COA processing is heavily dependent on manual work. Start with process mapping, baseline metrics and a focused automation use case.
24–35	DEVELOPING	Some digitization exists, but extraction, validation, exception handling or integration remains fragmented.
36–43	ADVANCED	The organization has a strong foundation for intelligent certificate automation. Focus on validation, traceability and integration depth.
44–48	READY TO SCALE	Your process is well positioned for enterprise-grade automation. Prioritize scale, governance, advanced validation and downstream workflow integration.

What Your Score Should Trigger

Regardless of score, the next step should be evidence-based. Select a representative sample of your actual MTRs/COAs and measure document variability, extraction accuracy, validation effort, exception rates, processing time and integration requirements.

Star Software can help you assess the opportunity. A practical discovery exercise can map your current certificate workflow, identify automation candidates and define measurable pilot criteria.

Your MTR/COA Automation Snapshot

Monthly certificate volume: _____

Approx. suppliers/formats: _____

Current ERP/QMS/LIMS: _____

Main pain point: _____

Target timeline: _____

ASSESS YOUR MTR/COA AUTOMATION READINESS

Extraction is only step one. Trusted, validated data is the real outcome.